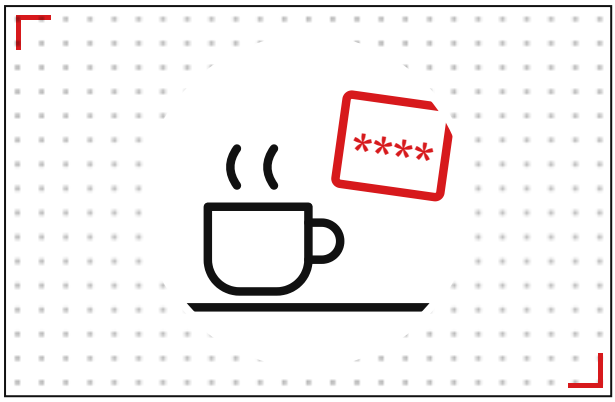
CYBERSTORIES #01

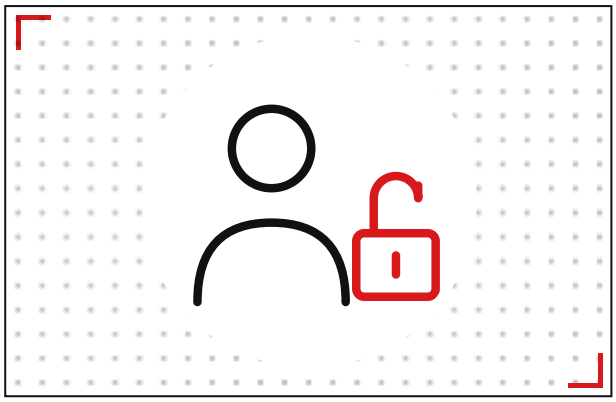


The Password in the Break Room

A visitor waits alone in the break room of an engineering company for his appointment. On the table lies an inconspicuous slip of paper. A few days later, confidential project data shows up on the internet.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #02

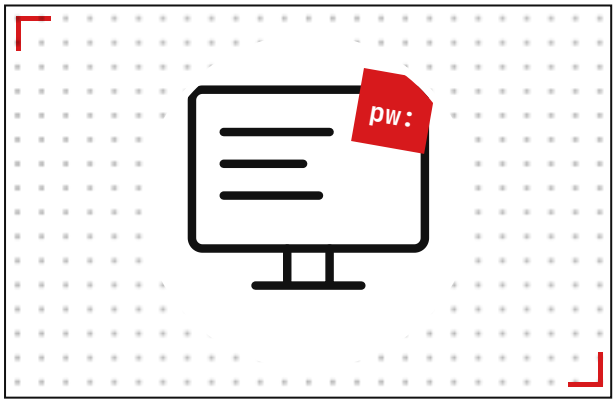


The Forgotten Account

Months after leaving the company, a former employee sends an old colleague a screenshot from the internal ERP system, showing today's date. Everyone is shocked.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #03



The Silent Dismissal

An employee arrives at the plant in the morning, but his badge no longer opens any doors and his company account is locked. Nobody has fired him, yet he has digitally “disappeared”.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #04



The Fake Invitation

Several engineers miss their weekly team meeting. Instead, they are sitting in a different online meeting, where their “team lead” asks an unusual number of questions about project details.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #02

The Forgotten Account

■□□ EASY

HINTS

1. The former employee didn't hack anything.
2. What should have happened on his last working day?

SOLUTION

His user account had simply never been disabled when he left. He could still log in from home and look at internal data. The mistake only came to light because of his screenshot.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **All access is revoked on an employee's last working day. That takes a fixed checklist shared by HR and IT.**

SOLUTION #01

The Password in the Break Room

■□□ EASY

HINTS

1. The note has nothing to do with the visitor. It belongs to an employee.
2. What do people write on notes they don't want to forget?

SOLUTION

An employee had written down his username and password on a slip of paper and left it behind during his break. The visitor, who was allowed to wait unaccompanied, took a photo of the note and later logged into the company network through the remote access (VPN). That is how the project data got out.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **Passwords belong in a password manager, not on paper. Visitors are accompanied, never left alone.**

SOLUTION #04

The Fake Invitation

■■■ HARD

HINTS

1. The invitation did not come from the team lead.
2. The face and voice in the meeting weren't real either.

SOLUTION

The engineers had received a fake calendar invitation. Attackers had used AI to write it in the team lead's typical style and scheduled it just before the real meeting. There was no real person in the meeting, only an AI-generated deepfake of the team lead who asked specific questions about development data.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **Invitations can be faked too. If a meeting is moved or the link looks unfamiliar, check with the sender through a channel you already know.**

SOLUTION #03

The Silent Dismissal

■■□ MEDIUM

HINTS

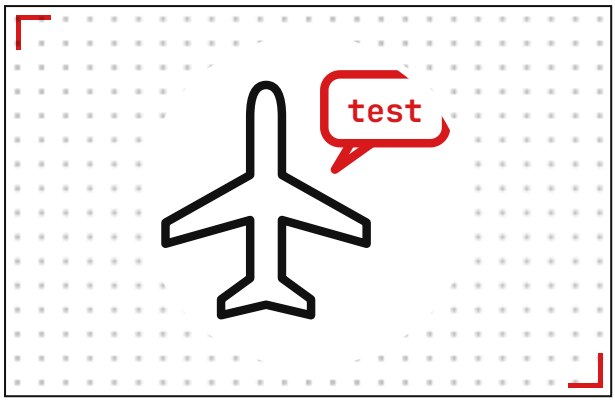
1. A colleague is behind it, for personal reasons.
2. The HR system automatically controls badges and accounts.

SOLUTION

An envious colleague had found the employee's password on a sticky note on his monitor. He used it to log into the HR system and recorded the employee as having left the company. That automatically triggered the blocking of his badge and account.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **A password on your monitor is a password for everyone. Whoever uses someone else's account acts in their name.**

CYBERSTORIES #05

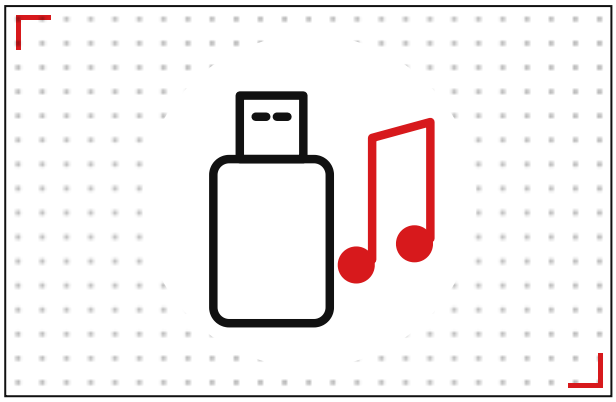


The Voice from Nowhere

In mid-flight, a pilot receives messages in the cockpit that nobody at his airline sent. The sender needed just one single word for this, twice.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #06



Ghost in the Machine

A CNC milling machine suddenly starts making faulty movements. The controller seems to have been tampered with, but nobody changed the program. The only difference from last week: there's music playing in the workshop now.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #07

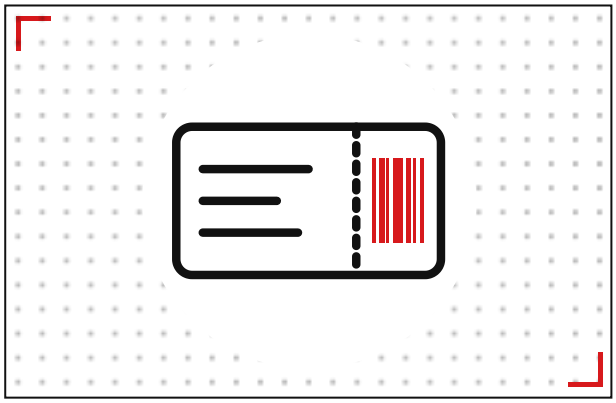


The Forgotten Laptop

A field sales rep returns from a business trip. The product he wanted to present as a novelty is now known to the competition as well.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #08



The Vanished Vacation

A couple is looking forward to their long-awaited vacation. At the airport they learn that their flights have been cancelled, supposedly by themselves.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #06

Ghost in the Machine

EASY

HINTS

1. The music isn't coming from the radio.
2. How does music get onto a computer without internet access?

SOLUTION

A colleague had plugged a private USB stick with music into the machine's computer so he could listen while he worked. The stick carried malware that launched itself when plugged in and embedded itself in the control software. The machine responded to false commands and production came to a halt.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **Private USB sticks have no place on company computers, and certainly not on machines.**

SOLUTION #05

The Voice from Nowhere

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. Messages to the cockpit go through a web portal on the ground.
2. That one word is both the username and the password.

SOLUTION

Airlines use a central portal run by a service provider to send text messages between the ground and the cockpit, such as flight plans or technical data. This portal had a test account with the username “test” and the password “test”. Anyone who tried it could send messages directly to pilots.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **Test and default accounts are deleted before going live. Attackers always try “test”, “admin” or “1234” first.**

SOLUTION #08

The Vanished Vacation

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The two were very proud of their trip and wanted to show it off.
2. A boarding pass shows more than the seat number and the time.

SOLUTION

Full of excitement, the couple had posted a photo of their boarding passes on social media. The boarding passes showed their names and the booking code. With many airlines, that's all you need to manage a booking online. A stranger logged in and cancelled the flights.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **Never post boarding passes, tickets or ID documents publicly. The barcodes and codes on them are login credentials.**

SOLUTION #07

The Forgotten Laptop

EASY

HINTS

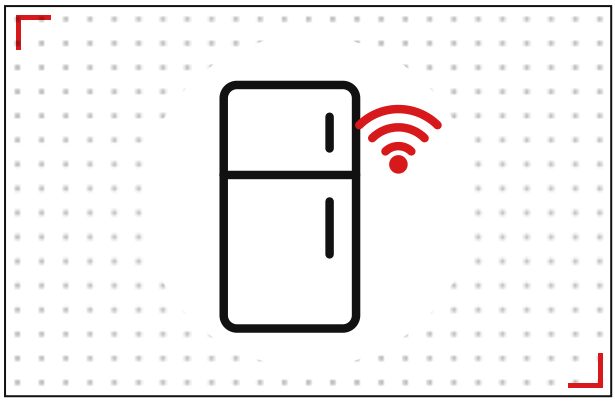
1. The employee didn't give anything away. He lost something.
2. A password at startup doesn't protect everything.

SOLUTION

He had left his laptop on the train. The laptop was protected with a login password, but the hard drive was not encrypted. The finder removed it and could easily read all the data. The design details ended up with a competitor.

> KEY TAKEAWAY
>
> **A login password does not protect the data on the hard drive. Only encryption does. Report a lost device to IT immediately.**

CYBERSTORIES #09



Slow Food

A man wonders why his internet has been so slow for weeks. When the technician arrives, he finds the cause in the kitchen.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #10

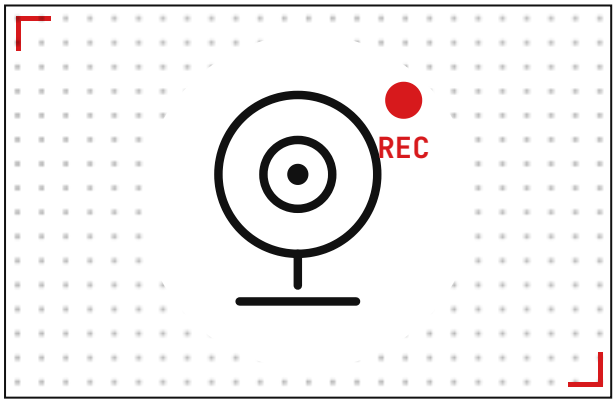


House Arrest

Shortly after writing an online review, a family can no longer leave their home.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #11

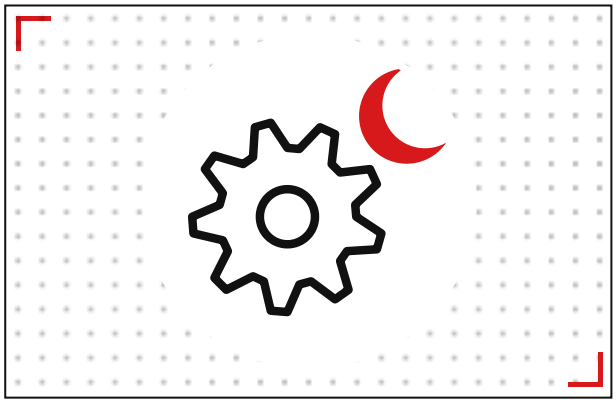


The See-Through Influencer

An influencer notices that private details from his daily life are appearing in an online forum, even though he never posted them.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #12



The Hard-Working Machine

A production manager is puzzled: a milling machine runs at night, even though nobody is in the plant.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #10

House Arrest

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The review was a bad one.
2. The doors are controlled by an app, and the family isn't the only one with access.

SOLUTION

The family had given the installer of their smart home system a bad review. During installation, he had secretly kept an administrator account for himself. Out of revenge, he locked all the electronic door locks remotely. Only an emergency reset by the manufacturer set the family free.

KEY TAKEAWAY

After a contractor sets up a system, change all passwords and check who still has access.

SOLUTION #09

Slow Food

EASY

HINTS

1. The fridge is connected to the internet.
2. It is secretly working for strangers.

SOLUTION

The smart fridge was running outdated firmware with a known security hole. Hackers had taken it over and made it part of a botnet, a network of many hijacked devices. Together they sent huge amounts of data to other websites to knock them offline (a DDoS attack). This traffic clogged up the home network.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Fridges, TVs and cameras need updates too. Anything that no longer gets updates doesn't belong on the internet.

SOLUTION #12

The Hard-Working Machine

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The machine is being controlled from outside the plant.
2. The manufacturer sometimes needs access, and that access was poorly protected.

SOLUTION

The machine was permanently connected to the internet through the manufacturer's remote maintenance module, unprotected and with a default login. Attackers found the access, started programs on the machine and copied the stored machining programs and production data.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Use remote maintenance only through secured access, and switch it on only when it's needed.

SOLUTION #11

The See-Through Influencer

EASY

HINTS

1. Someone really is watching.
2. The device is in the apartment and hasn't been used for ages.

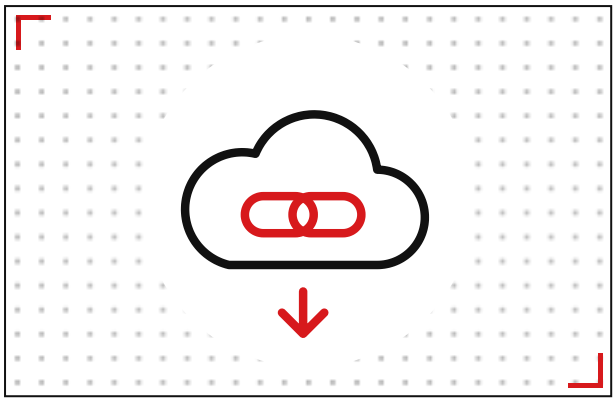
SOLUTION

An old webcam he had long forgotten about was still hanging in his apartment. It was still connected to the Wi-Fi and reachable over the internet with the manufacturer's default password. A fan found it, watched the influencer's daily life for weeks and published what he saw.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Always change default passwords. Disconnect devices you no longer use.

CYBERSTORIES #13

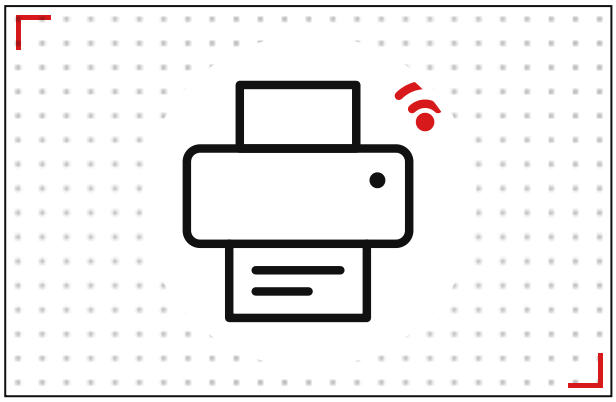


The Open Door

A supplier contacts the engineering company: suddenly he can see internal project data he never asked for.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #14



The Printer That Knew Too Much

A construction drawing is printed only once. A few days later it appears on the internet, even though nobody passed it on.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #15

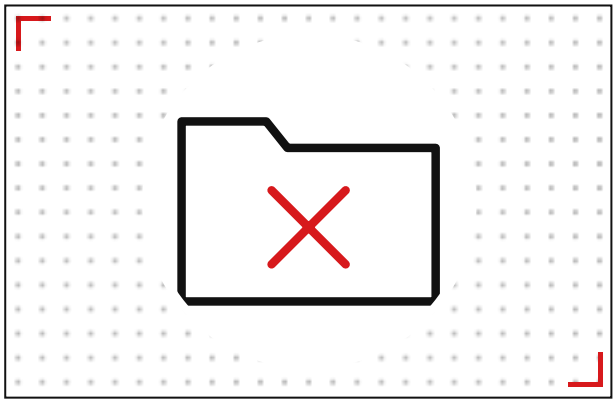


Final Regards

An entire company comes to a standstill. Every screen shows a single sentence: “You forgot about me.”

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #16



The Missing Assembly

A design engineer wants to open an important CAD file from the network drive, but it has vanished. Nobody deleted it with bad intentions.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #14

The Printer That Knew Too Much

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. No person passed the drawing on, but a device did.
2. The device is connected to the internet and hasn't been updated in a long time.

SOLUTION

The network printer had never been updated and was reachable from the internet. Attackers had taken it over and had a copy of every print job sent to them. That is how the confidential plans got out.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Printers are computers. They need updates and strong passwords too, and they don't belong on the open internet.

SOLUTION #13

The Open Door

EASY

HINTS

1. It was a mistake, not an attack.
2. The supplier was only supposed to receive a single file.

SOLUTION

A project manager wanted to send the supplier just one drawing and shared a link from the cloud storage to do so. By mistake, he shared the entire project folder, with “anyone with the link” and without a password or expiry date. Luckily, the supplier was honest.

KEY TAKEAWAY

When sharing, check exactly what you are sharing and with whom. Give share links an expiry date.

SOLUTION #16

The Missing Assembly

EASY

HINTS

1. A colleague just wanted to tidy up.
2. There is no copy of the file.

SOLUTION

The file was in a folder that every employee had full access to. A colleague did some “spring cleaning” and deleted everything *he* didn't need. Because the drive wasn't backed up, the file was lost for good.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Everyone gets only the permissions they need. Important data is backed up regularly, and restoring it is tested.

SOLUTION #15

Final Regards

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The sentence comes from a former employee.
2. His official account was blocked, but he still had a second way in.

SOLUTION

While working at the company, an administrator had secretly set up his own remote access to the servers. When he left, his official accounts were blocked, but nobody knew about the backdoor. Months later he used it, launched encryption software on all systems and left the message behind.

KEY TAKEAWAY

When an administrator leaves, blocking their account is not enough. Also change shared passwords and review remote access.

CYBERSTORIES #17



The Boss on the Screen

After a video call with the boss and several colleagues, the accounting team urgently transfers a large sum abroad. Later it turns out that none of the participants knew anything about the call.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #18

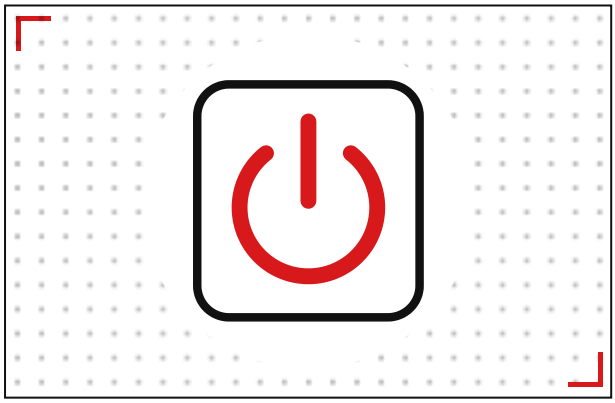


Locked Out

A long-serving IT employee is dismissed, and all his access is blocked the same day. Even so, the company comes to a standstill a few weeks later.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #19

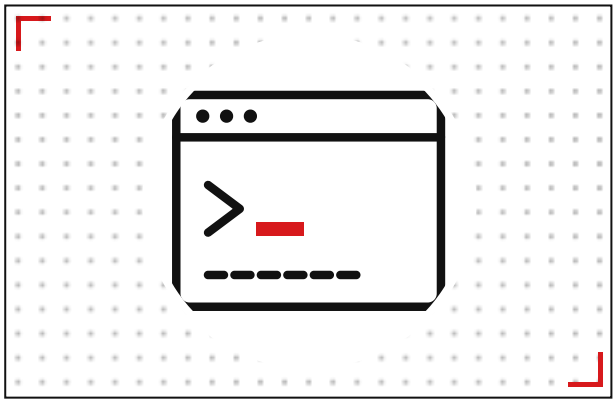


Nothing Works Without Me

When an employee has responsibilities taken away from him, servers suddenly keep crashing. The day after he is fired, nobody in the company can log in any more.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #20



The False Helper

An employee wants to fix his computer problem himself and searches the internet for help. Shortly afterwards, the company's security systems sound the alarm.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #18

Locked Out

■■■ HARD

HINTS

1. The former employee didn't hack his way in. He was given access.
2. He simply called and pretended to be someone else.

SOLUTION

The former employee called the IT help desk and posed as an external service provider. Because he knew the processes, names and jargon, nobody checked him properly and he was given new access. He used it to change the passwords of around 2,500 employees and suppliers, locking them out of the IT systems.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **Anyone asking for access or passwords over the phone gets verified, no matter how familiar they sound. Insider knowledge is not an ID.**

SOLUTION #17

The Boss on the Screen

■■■ MEDIUM

HINTS

1. None of the colleagues in the call were real.
2. AI can imitate faces and voices.

SOLUTION

Apart from the accountant, every participant in the video call was a deepfake. Attackers had used AI to recreate faces and voices from public videos. The “boss” stressed that the matter was urgent and strictly confidential. A similar case cost an international engineering firm around 25 million US dollars in 2024.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **For payment requests with time pressure and secrecy, always call back through a channel you know. Unusual payments need a second approval.**

SOLUTION #20

The False Helper

■■■ MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The help page wasn't genuine.
2. The employee typed something into his PC himself.

SOLUTION

The help page he found was a fake set up by scammers. It told him to copy a command and paste it into his PC's command line. Instead of fixing the problem, the command downloaded malware and ran it.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **Never copy and run commands from the internet. For IT problems, ask your own IT support.**

SOLUTION #19

Nothing Works Without Me

■■■ HARD

HINTS

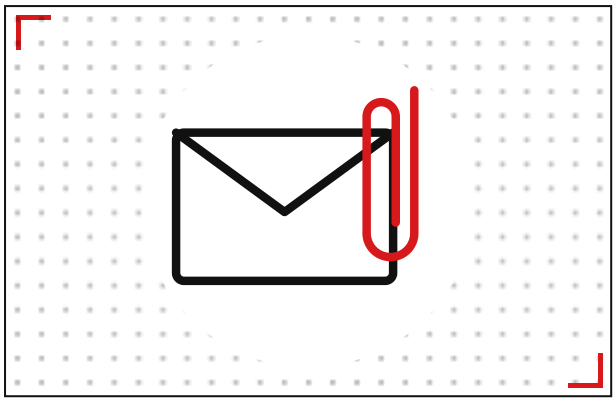
1. The employee caused the problems himself, out of frustration.
2. A program was waiting for his account to be blocked.

SOLUTION

Out of frustration, the developer had hidden his own malware on the servers, which overloaded them again and again. He also built a “kill switch”: a program that checked whether his account was still active. When his account was blocked after his dismissal, the program automatically locked the accounts of all other employees.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **No single person should be able to make critical changes to systems alone. The four-eyes principle and regular checks also protect against insiders.**

CYBERSTORIES #21

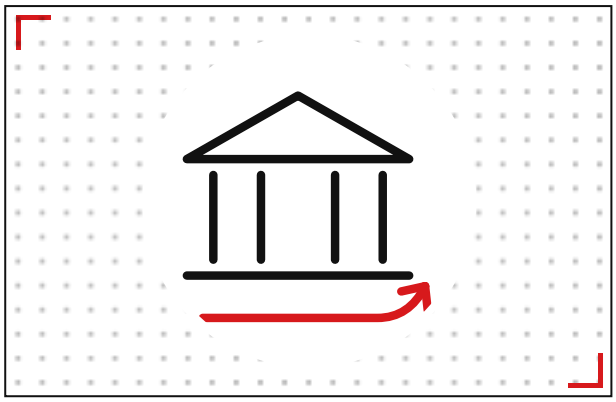


The Urgent Invoice

Monday morning: someone in accounting opens an invoice. By Wednesday, every production line in the plant has stopped.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #22

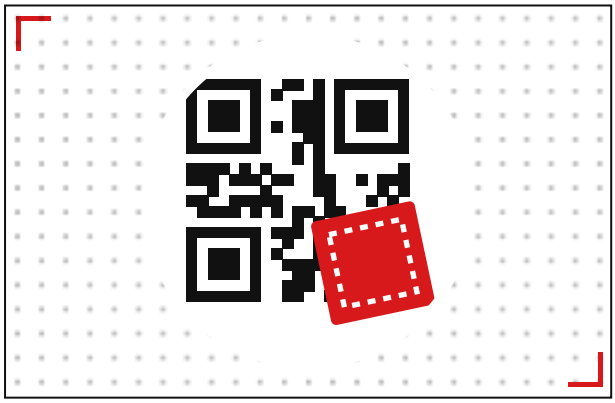


New Bank Details

An engineering company pays every invoice from its most important supplier on time and in full. Even so, after three months the supplier threatens to stop deliveries.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #23

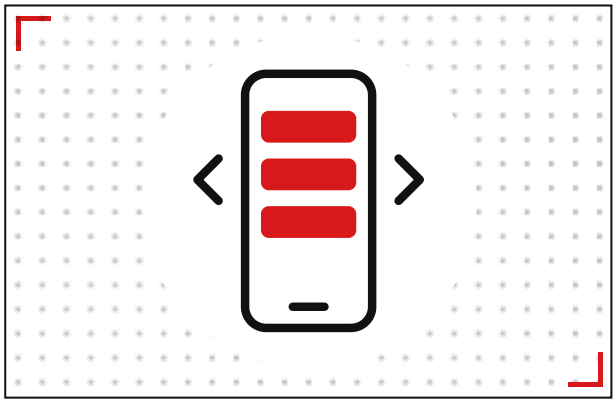


The Parking Code

An employee pays for parking at the train station with his phone. A week later, his company email account has been hijacked.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #24



The Night of a Thousand Requests

An employee is woken up by his phone again and again during the night. Eventually, annoyed, he taps “Yes”. The next morning the company network is in someone else's hands.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #22

New Bank Details

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The money never reached the supplier.
2. An email made sure the payments went to a different account.

SOLUTION

The purchasing department had received an email: “Our bank details have changed, please only transfer to this account from now on.” The sender's address looked almost exactly like the real one, with just one letter swapped. Since then, every payment had gone to fraudsters.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Always confirm changed bank details by phone with the supplier, using the number you already know, not the one in the email.

SOLUTION #21

The Urgent Invoice

EASY

HINTS

1. The invoice was an email with an attachment.
2. The attachment wanted something to be “enabled”.

SOLUTION

The “invoice” arrived by email from a supposed supplier with the subject line “Final reminder”. The attachment was an Office document that asked the reader to “enable content” to view it. That launched malware, which spread unnoticed through the network for two days and then encrypted all the servers, including production planning.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Be suspicious of unexpected attachments and time pressure. Never click “enable content” unless you are sure where the file came from.

SOLUTION #24

The Night of a Thousand Requests

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The phone was showing login requests.
2. The attackers already knew his password. All they needed was his “Yes”.

SOLUTION

The attackers already knew his password. All they were missing was the confirmation in the app (two-factor login). So they kept triggering login attempts until the employee approved one of them, just to get some peace. In 2022, attackers got into the network of a large ride-hailing company in a similar way.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Only approve logins you have just started yourself. Report unexpected requests to IT immediately: they mean your password is already known.

SOLUTION #23

The Parking Code

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The mistake happened while paying at the machine.
2. He used a password there that he also uses at work.

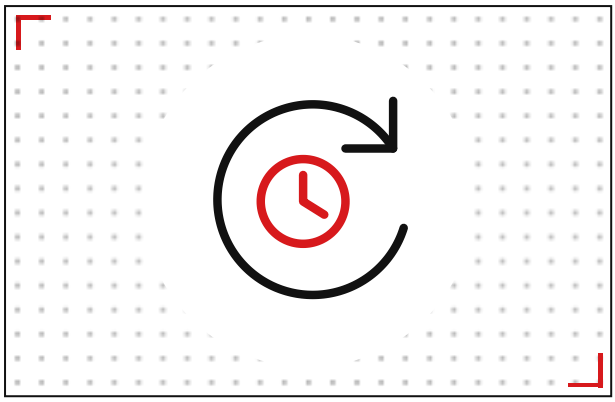
SOLUTION

A fake QR code had been stuck onto the parking machine. It led to a payment page that required an account to sign in. The employee used his work email and the same password he uses at the company. The scammers simply tried the details on the company portal.

KEY TAKEAWAY

QR codes can be fake, especially in public places. And use a different password for every service.

CYBERSTORIES #25

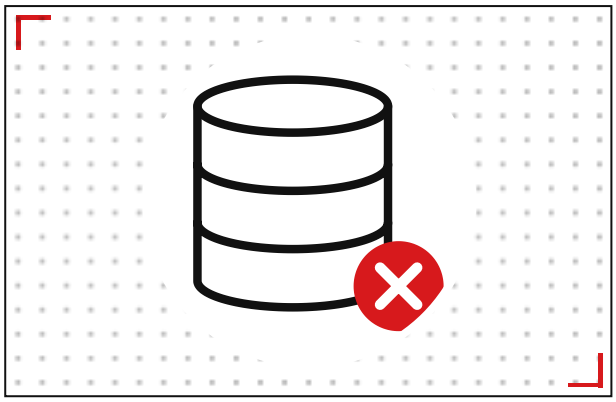


Tomorrow Is Another Day

For weeks, an employee has clicked the same button every morning. One day, his computer becomes the starting point of an attack on the entire company.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #26

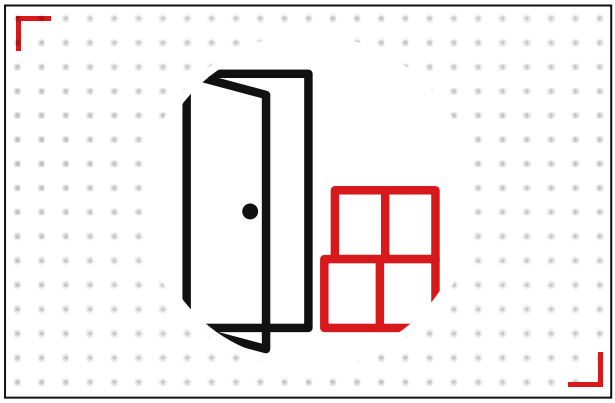


The Backup That Wasn't

After a hacker attack, all the servers are encrypted. IT stays calm, since there are daily backups. An hour later, the calm is gone.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #27

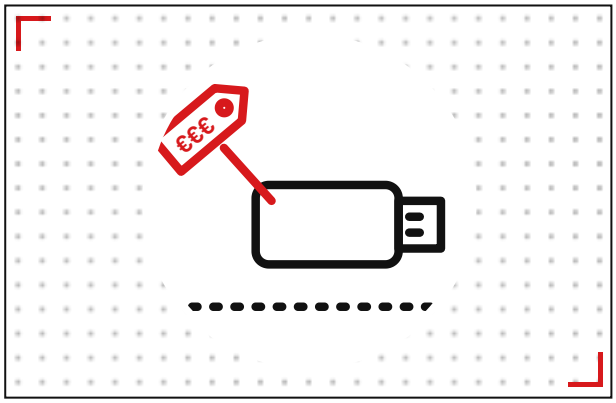


The Polite Colleague

An employee kindly holds the door open for a man carrying two heavy boxes. Two weeks later, data is leaking out of the company network, even though nobody gave away a password.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #28



Lost and Found

An employee finds something in the company car park and honestly wants to return it. Shortly afterwards, the security systems sound the alarm.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #26

The Backup That Wasn't

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The backups no longer exist.
2. The attackers could reach the backups just as easily as the servers.

SOLUTION

The backups were stored on a system in the same network and could be reached with the same administrator account. The attackers deleted the backups first and only then encrypted the servers.

KEY TAKEAWAY

At least one backup must be kept offline or in a form that can't be changed. And restoring from it must be practised regularly.

SOLUTION #25

Tomorrow Is Another Day

EASY

HINTS

1. The button appears when the computer wants to install something.
2. It brings changes that close security holes.

SOLUTION

The button was “Remind me later”. Because the restart was always inconvenient, the employee kept postponing an important security update. Attackers exploited exactly the hole that the update would have closed. Through a manipulated website they got onto his computer and from there into the company network.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Updates close holes that attackers already know about. Install security updates promptly, even if the restart is annoying.

SOLUTION #28

Lost and Found

EASY

HINTS

1. She wanted to find out who the item belonged to.
2. It had been placed there on purpose.

SOLUTION

She had found a USB stick labelled “Salaries 2026” and plugged it into her computer to find out who it belonged to. Attackers had “lost” the stick there deliberately. When she opened the file, malware started.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Never plug in USB sticks you find. Hand them in to IT. Curiosity and helpfulness are the attackers' tools.

SOLUTION #27

The Polite Colleague

EASY

HINTS

1. The man with the boxes doesn't work at the company.
2. He left something behind in the building.

SOLUTION

The man with the boxes was no colleague. Inside the building, he plugged an inconspicuous little box into an unused network socket behind a photocopier. The device connected to the attackers over the mobile network and gave them direct access to the internal network.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Letting strangers through the door bypasses every access control. It's fine to ask politely: “Who are you here to see?”

CYBERSTORIES #29

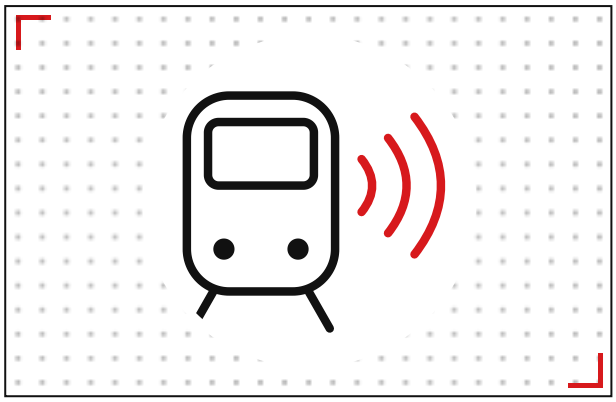


Free Wi-Fi

A sales rep sits in a hotel lobby working on his quotes as usual. The next day, a competitor undercuts his offer to the exact euro.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #30

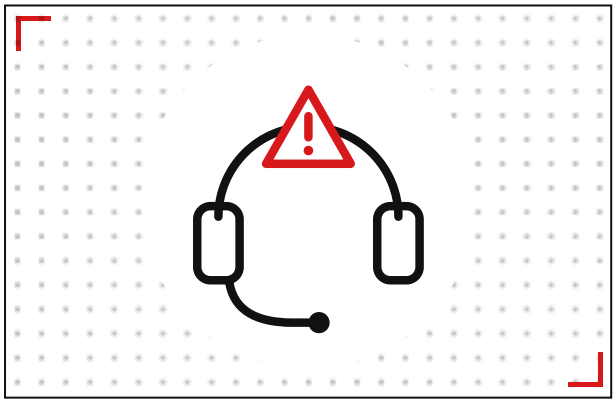


The Call on the Train

A project manager takes the express train home. The next day, a “colleague from IT” calls his assistant, and she is happy to help him.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #31

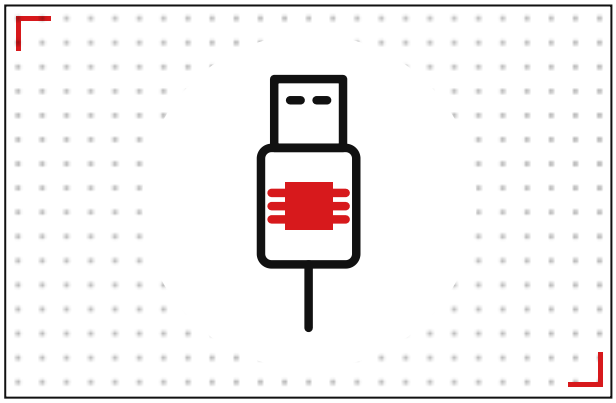


The Helpful Support Desk

IT calls an employee to fix a problem he didn't even know he had. He is grateful for the quick help. But the trouble only starts after the call.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #32



The Trade Fair Gift

An engineer returns enthusiastic from a trade fair and uses his new giveaway at the office. Shortly afterwards, IT reports an infected computer.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #30

The Call on the Train

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The caller knew things only insiders know.
2. The knowledge came from the train.

SOLUTION

On the train, the project manager had made a loud phone call: project name, customer name, the names of his team, and that he would be on vacation the next day. A fellow passenger took notes. With that knowledge, his call to the assistant sounded so convincing that she gave him the login details for the project drive.

KEY TAKEAWAY

In public, others are always listening. Confidential calls and screens don't belong on trains, in cafés or in waiting areas.

SOLUTION #29

Free Wi-Fi

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The mistake happened when he connected to the internet.
2. Not every Wi-Fi network with the hotel's name belongs to the hotel.

SOLUTION

There were two Wi-Fi networks in the lobby with almost the same name. An attacker had set one of them up with a small device. Because the sales rep connected without a VPN, the attacker could read his traffic and log into his webmail account.

KEY TAKEAWAY

On public Wi-Fi always use the company VPN, or better still, your work phone's hotspot.

SOLUTION #32

The Trade Fair Gift

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The giveaway gets plugged into the computer.
2. It's more than just a cable.

SOLUTION

The stand of a supposed exhibitor was handing out free USB charging cables. The plug contained a tiny chip that pretended to be a keyboard and typed in commands within seconds, which downloaded malware.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Unknown USB devices, including cables, fans and power banks, don't belong on company computers. Use giveaways with a USB plug on a wall charger instead.

SOLUTION #31

The Helpful Support Desk

EASY

HINTS

1. The caller wasn't from IT.
2. The employee was asked to install a program.

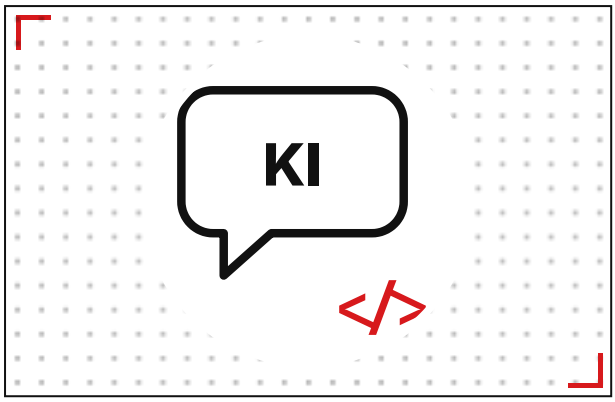
SOLUTION

The caller pretended to be from IT support and claimed that the employee's computer was spreading viruses through the network. He asked him to install a remote access program and read out the code it displayed. With that, the attacker had full control of the computer.

KEY TAKEAWAY

IT doesn't call out of the blue and ask for remote access. If in doubt, hang up and call back on the IT number you know.

CYBERSTORIES #33

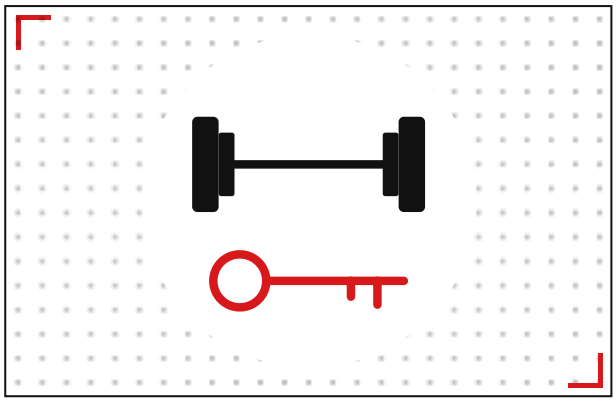


The Eager Assistant

A developer is proud: he has solved a difficult problem in record time. A few weeks later, management bans a popular tool for everyone.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #34

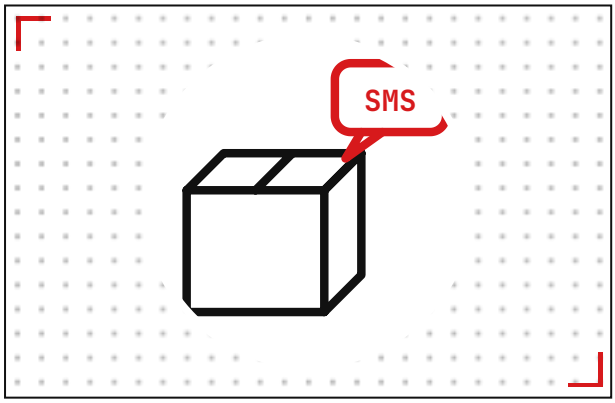


The Fitness Password

An employee signed up for a fitness app to get more exercise. Six months later, someone logs into the company network with his account.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #35

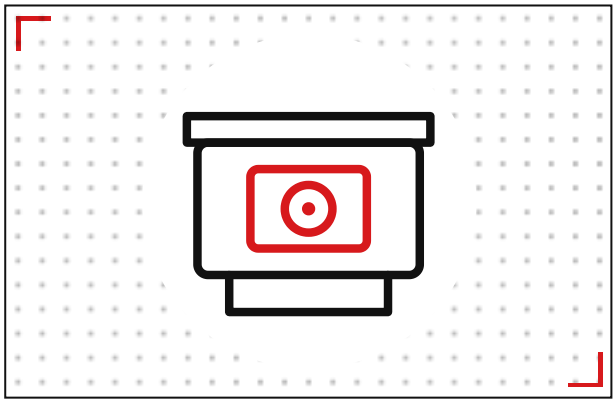


The Parcel That Never Came

An employee is expecting a delivery and taps a link in a text message. A few days later, all his business contacts are getting strange messages from him.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #36



A Bargain Online

A student buys a used office photocopier for very little money on an online marketplace. Shortly afterwards, he contacts a newspaper.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #34

The Fitness Password

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The fitness app was hacked.
2. The employee isn't very creative when it comes to passwords.

SOLUTION

The fitness app was hacked and the login details of all its users were published online. The employee had used the same email address and the same password there as for his company account. Attackers automatically try lists like these on many services.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Every account needs its own password. A password manager remembers them for you.

SOLUTION #33

The Eager Assistant

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The tool helped him solve the problem.
2. To do that, he had to hand it company data.

SOLUTION

The developer had copied confidential source code and internal meeting notes into a public AI chatbot to get help. That put the data on someone else's servers, where, depending on the service, it could even be used for training. Exactly this happened at a large electronics company in 2023.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Only enter confidential data into AI tools the company has approved.

SOLUTION #36

A Bargain Online

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The student found something inside the device.
2. Photocopiers have a memory.

SOLUTION

The photocopier came from the company and had been handed to a dealer when it was replaced. What nobody had thought about: the copier had a built-in hard drive that stored every scanned and copied document. It held personnel files, contracts and engineering drawings.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Have devices with storage, including photocopiers, printers, phones and machine controllers, securely wiped before disposal.

SOLUTION #35

The Parcel That Never Came

EASY

HINTS

1. The text message wasn't from the delivery company.
2. The link installed something on the phone.

SOLUTION

The text message claimed to be from a parcel service and asked him to install a “tracking app”. The app was malware. It read the contacts on his work phone and used it to send out more fraudulent text messages.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Only install apps from the official stores. Parcel texts with a link are almost always a scam. Enter the tracking number directly on the delivery company's website.

CYBERSTORIES #37

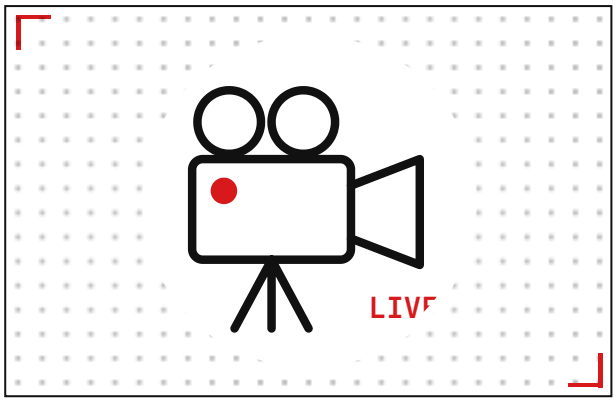


In the Recycling

A competitor launches a machine that looks strikingly similar to your own, even though the plans never left the building. Or did they?

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #38

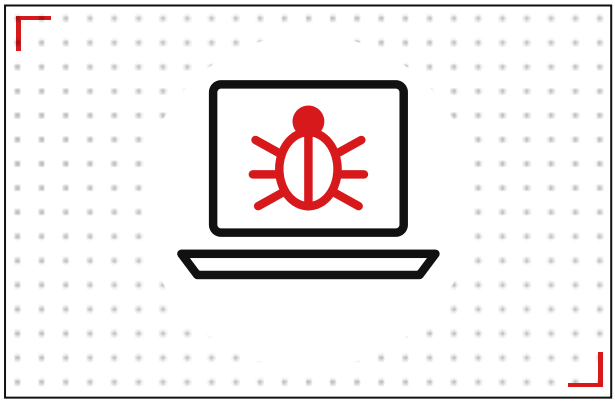


The Interview

A TV crew films a proud report about the company's new production hall. On the evening after it airs, someone logs into the machines.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #39

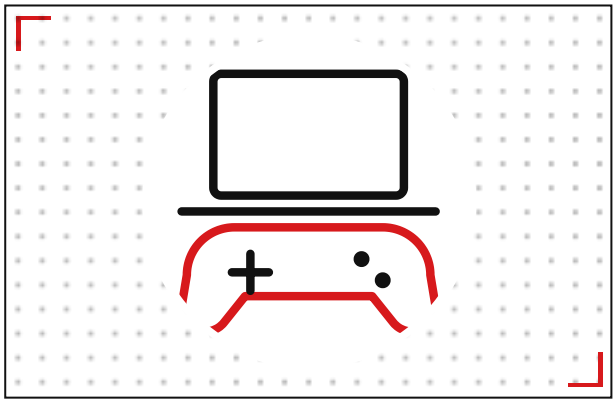


The Technician's Laptop

A service technician from the machine manufacturer repairs a system one morning. In the afternoon, the machines in the entire hall fail one after another.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

CYBERSTORIES #40



Just a Little Game

A father is working from home. At the weekend he just quickly did something for his daughter. On Monday, IT blocks his laptop.

RIDDLE Yes-or-no questions only

SOLUTION #38

The Interview

EASY

HINTS

1. The information was shown on TV, quite unintentionally.
2. Pay attention to the background of the interview.

SOLUTION

In the background of the interview, a note with the username and password for the plant controls was hanging at the control station, easy to read in HD. Viewers took screenshots. In 2015, a French TV channel accidentally showed its own passwords in the news in exactly this way.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **Before photos, videos and video calls, check what's visible in the background: whiteboards, screens, notes.**

SOLUTION #37

In the Recycling

EASY

HINTS

1. The plans left the building on paper.
2. Nobody stole them. They were thrown away.

SOLUTION

Old printouts of engineering drawings had ended up in the ordinary paper recycling container in the yard, freely accessible to anyone. Someone had searched the container regularly for weeks.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **Confidential paper goes into the locked confidential waste bin or the shredder, never into ordinary paper recycling.**

SOLUTION #40

Just a Little Game

EASY

HINTS

1. The daughter was allowed to use the laptop.
2. She installed something that was free.

SOLUTION

The daughter wanted to play a game on the powerful company laptop and install a free add-on for it. Her father had logged her in with his account. The add-on contained a program that read the passwords stored in the browser, including the logins for the company portal.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **Company devices are for work only and only for the person they belong to, including when working from home.**

SOLUTION #39

The Technician's Laptop

MEDIUM

HINTS

1. The cause came into the hall with the technician.
2. His laptop had been at another customer's site before.

SOLUTION

The technician plugged his own laptop directly into the production network to service the system. The laptop had been infected with malware at a previous customer. Because the production network wasn't divided into separate zones, the malware spread from machine to machine.

> **KEY TAKEAWAY**
>
> **Outside devices only join the network after a check and through a separate connection. Production networks are divided into zones so that one problem doesn't hit the whole hall.**